

A WEEKLY FOR THE SECOND ACT

Encore

For people whose best work is still ahead.

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THE OPENING

You're not retiring. You're reloading.

The day I stopped being a CEO, everyone treated it like an ending. There were speeches. Someone used the word "legacy." A man I respect leaned in and asked, with real kindness, what I was going to *do all day*.

I smiled and said something about golf. But here's what I was actually thinking: **I have never had more to give than I do right now.** Four books behind me, a creative side I'd kept in a drawer for thirty years finally awake, a town I love, and — for the first time since I was twenty-two — the freedom to choose the work instead of the work choosing me. That's not a finish line. That's a starting gun.

I kept meeting people who felt the same and had nowhere to put it. The founder who sold her company and was bored of leisure inside a month. The lawyer who finally has time to build the nonprofit he's described for years. The executive with one more company in him and the scars to do it right this time. People with capital, judgment, curiosity — and a stack of brochures about decline that have nothing to do with their actual lives.

So I'm making the thing I wanted to read. **Encore** is a weekly for the people who aren't done — the second-act founders, the late-blooming makers, the angels and mentors and explorers. No ads, no one selling your attention. Just the playbooks, the people, and the proof that the most defining chapter of a life can start at sixty.

If that's you — and I think it might be — pull up a chair.

— [Your Name], founder

THE ENCORE PROFILE

The man who started over at 62 — with a recipe and a car

Harland Sanders · a historical exemplar (public record)

By the time most people meet his face on a bucket, Harland Sanders had already failed at nearly everything. Farmhand, streetcar conductor, railroad worker, insurance salesman, ferry operator, gas-station owner — a résumé of false starts stretching across decades. At 62, a new interstate routed traffic away from the roadside restaurant he'd built in Corbin, Kentucky, and he was, more or less, broke.

So he got in his car. He drove from restaurant to restaurant, cooking his pressure-fried chicken for owners and proposing a then-novel idea — pay me a nickel for every bird you sell with my recipe. Most said no. He kept driving, sleeping in the back seat. The model that came to be called *franchising* took hold one handshake at a time. He sold Kentucky Fried Chicken in 1964 — at 75 — and spent the rest of his long life as the most recognizable face in fast food.

The encore lesson isn't "fried chicken." It's that the work people remember you for can begin at the exact age the world has decided you're finished. Sanders had his whole résumé — every failure included — as raw material. The second act used all of it.

You're in good company. Julia Child published her first cookbook at 49 and found television around 51 · Vera Wang entered fashion at 40 · Momofuku Ando invented Cup Noodles at 61 · Toni Morrison published her first novel at 39. (*Future issues profile living Encore members — interviewed, in their own words.*)

THE PLAYBOOK

Your first move as an angel investor

Plenty of second-act readers want to put a little capital behind founders — and have more to offer than money. A grounded way to start, in five moves:

1. **Decide what you can lose.** Angel investing is high-risk; size your total allocation as money you could write to zero without changing your life. A common rule of thumb is a small single-digit percentage of investable assets.
2. **Start in a syndicate or fund, not solo.** Writing small checks alongside experienced leads (via a syndicate or a seed fund) buys you diversification and deal flow before you ever pick alone.

3. **Spread small bets wide.** Returns are driven by the rare winner; many checks beat one "conviction" bet. Plan for most to fail.
4. **Lead with your scar tissue.** Your operating experience — hiring, selling, surviving — is worth more to a founder than your check. The best deals come to people known for being useful.
5. **Write the check you'll be calm about.** If a position keeps you up at night, it's too big. The point of a second-act portfolio is energy, not anxiety.

General education, not investment advice — Encore doesn't sell financial products or take placement fees.

THE TABLE · where members meet (a preview)

The best part of Encore isn't written by me — it's the room. Members post what they're building and what they can offer. A sample of what The Table sounds like:

Seeking → Former healthcare CEO (62) looking for an operating partner to buy and run a profitable HVAC business in the Southeast. I bring capital + governance; you run it.

Offering → Just published my first novel at 67. Happy to share everything I learned about self-publishing — covers, editors, launch. Ask me anything.

Forming → Angel group for second-act founders — five seats, \$25K minimum, first close in September. Reply for the deck.

Offering → Retired general counsel offering pro-bono board-governance help to two nonprofits this year. Point me at a good one.

Illustrative posts for the sample. The Table opens to members at launch.

LAST WORD

"Retirement is the only finish line you're allowed to move."

— [Your Name]

Join the second act.

The weekly is free. **Members get The Table** — the directory, the asks-and-offers, the intros, the dinners and retreats. Founding memberships open soon; reply to claim your place in line.

Reserve a founding membership →

Encore

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